

system depends on the features supported and technologies used with scalability. It also varies with the brand and application.

Home security systems are available as standalone systems or monitored systems, where a monitored system is connected to a 24x7 monitoring centre. Standalone systems start at around Rs 8000 for a basic package with additional installation charges. An installed monitored system costs around Rs 14,000 onwards for the basic package, which includes one year of 24x7 monitoring service.

Standalone/multi-apartment video doorphones are available in B&W and colour. Standalone video doorphones and intrusion alarms, each costing below Rs 10,000, are very affordable.

Security systems integrated with home automation features cost anywhere between Rs 100,000 and Rs 350,000 per home depending upon the features.

What's available?

Home security systems can be centered around an alarm, a system of intercoms, locking systems or video cameras. Determine the needs of your home depending on the surrounding environment.

Intrusion alarm system. Alarms can be either silent or very loud. A loud alarm will either frighten the intruder

Providers of Security Systems

In India, there are today many companies offering home security products. Prominent among them are Zicom, Samridhi Automations, Honeywell and ADT Security. Digihome, an Aftex Group company, offers home automation solutions for smart homes. Jaymit Systems, a trading concern of Vishal Electronics, which is engaged in the manufacture of CCTVs in India, offers products like alarm systems, CCTV access control, IP cameras, IR cameras, dome cameras, doorphones and electronic safes.

away or alert the neighbours that someone is trying to invade your house. Alarms fitted into the door sound right at the point of entry. Others can be connected (through wires or wirelessly) to a central control pad, which sounds if any point of entry is breached.

Generally, an intrusion alarm system has different sensors, magnetic contacts, hooters, etc linked to a control panel. An auto dialer with a pre-recorded message can also be integrated, which will automatically dial the fed numbers and leave emergency message. With this feature, if someone intrudes your home, the security system will call the police directly to inform them.

While selecting a warning alarm system, ensure that:

1. It doesn't produce false alarm
2. It has enough battery backup to

Sensors That Can be Attached to Home Alarm Systems

Magnetic sensor. It detects unauthorised entry through the door/window. One unit of the magnetic sensor is installed on the frame of the door/window that is fixed on the wall and the other unit is installed on the door/window. When there is an intrusion, the magnetic contacts are released and the signal is sent to the main panel informing of an intrusion.

Motion sensor. This sophisticated device detects unauthorised human body movement in your home when the home alarm system is activated. It is generally installed in the living room/bedroom of the home.

Glass-break sensor. It detects the breakage of framed glass, thus protecting your home from intrusion through the windows.

Gas-leak detector. This sensor takes away the worry of a gas leak, be it CNG or LPG. It can be used standalone or integrated with the main panel. The sensor is installed in the kitchen in close proximity to the gas cylinder/pipeline.

Smoke detector. This sensor is used to detect smoke that can be generated either by short circuit or fire. Zicom's smoke detector helps you evade losses due to fire before the fire erupts by sending an alarm through its main panel to the central monitoring station while an in-built buzzer warns people in the vicinity.

—Santonu Choudhury, CEO, Zicom Retail

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